

Anti-Asian racism and counter-perspectives in Europe and the Americas: bridging academic research and civil society action towards racial justice



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(password: adrw2026)

Organizers:

Hyunjung Lee, Leipzig University, Asian Voices Europe
Sayaka Osanami Törngren, Malmö University
Kimiko Suda, Humboldt-University Berlin

Purpose of the workshop

The aim of this project is to organize a two-day workshop that brings together scholars, cultural artists, and community organizers to critically engage with anti-Asian racism (AAR) from transnational, interdisciplinary, and intersectional perspectives. Through this, the workshop seeks to:

1. map existing theoretical and empirical research on AAR in Europe and identify key gaps;
2. connect Asian diasporic actors working across different sectors who have developed practical strategies to combat racism;
3. foster collaboration by generating new project ideas and co-developing funding applications; and
4. build a sustainable network that amplifies East and Southeast Asian diasporic perspectives in Europe and the Americas, while developing shared frameworks and political strategies for racial justice.

Content of the workshop

Day 1 will focus on emerging academic research, including studies on AAR, representation politics, and archival practices of marginalized communities. Panels will present comparative case studies from Europe, the U.S., and Latin America, fostering interdisciplinary dialogue across sociology, political science, migration studies, cultural studies, and memory studies.

Day 2 will highlight activist and artistic perspectives, with sessions on queer-feminist interventions, labor organizing, and Korean adoptee activism. It will emphasize creative resistance—through theater, film, literature, and community organizing—and policy engagement via anti-racist strategies within national and EU frameworks.

The questions we explore in the two-day workshop are:

1. How can racial justice be theorized and materialized for Asian diaspora communities in Europe, especially in the context of resurging ethno-nationalism and structural racism?
2. What theoretical and empirical research exists on AAR in Europe, and how can it be expanded to inform policy and practice?
3. How do Asian diasporic communities represent themselves in ways that challenge dominant narratives and counter AAR?
4. What are the challenges and possibilities in bridging academic research with civil society action to address AAR?
5. How can we build sustainable, transnational, and interdisciplinary collaborations that center marginalized perspectives and advance Asian diasporic solidarities and racial justice?

Workshop schedule

DAY 1, August 27, 2026

“New East and Southeast Asian diasporic perspectives in research and on public discourse”

Time	Topic	Participants and moderator
09:00 - 09:10	Welcome & organizational remarks	Hyunjung Lee, <i>Asian Voices Europe</i> Kimiko Suda, <i>Humboldt-University Berlin</i>
09:10 - 09:50	Keynote: Intersectional Approaches to Addressing Anti-Asian Racism: Moving Towards Racial Justice & Liberation	Nadine Nakamura, <i>Alliant University</i>
09:50 - 10:15	Q&A	Linda Juang, <i>University of Potsdam</i>
10:15 - 10:30	Short break	
10:30 - 11:30	Panel 1: AAR in quantitative research in Europe and the USA	Dawn Cheong, <i>Asian Voices Europe</i> Linda Juang, <i>University of Potsdam</i> Tae Jun Kim, <i>Dezim e.V.</i> Richard Lee, <i>University of Minnesota Twin Cities</i>
11:30 - 12:00	Q&A	Hyunjung Lee, <i>Asian Voices Europe</i>
12:00 - 13:00	Lunch break	
13:00 - 14:00	Panel 2: Qualitative case studies on AAR and counter-narratives (self-representation)	Grazia Ting Deng, <i>Brandeis University</i> Aya Ezawa, <i>Leiden University</i> Shujianing Li, <i>University of Minnesota Twin Cities</i> Simeng Wang, <i>The French National Centre for Scientific Research (CNRS)</i>
14:00 - 14:30	Q&A	Teresa Swartz, <i>University of Minnesota Twin Cities</i>
14:30 - 15:30	Panel 3: Young scholars' panel	Somi Dubuque, <i>researcher, Berlin</i> Pei Li, <i>U. Frankfurt & Queer Squad (e.V. i. G.)</i> Veronica Reyes, <i>Kapwa ASBL</i> Danila Tran-Thuy-Duong, <i>Martin-Luther University Halle-Wittenberg</i> Zhilin Wu, <i>University of Groningen</i>
15:30 - 16:00	Q&A	Feng-Mei Heberer, <i>New York University & University of Hong Kong</i>
16:00 - 16:15	Coffee break	
16:15 - 17:15	Roundtable 1: Transpacific perspectives on public memory and Asian diasporic archive(s)	Sun-Ju Choi, <i>korientation e.V.</i> Nataly Han, <i>Korea verband e.V.</i> Charlotte Ming, <i>journalist, writer, and artist, Berlin</i> Iris Rajanayagam, <i>Federal Agency for Civic Education</i> Sina Schindler, <i>korientation e.V. & Initiative in Gedenken an Phan Văn Toàn</i>
17:15 - 17:45	Q&A	Kimiko Suda, <i>Humboldt-University Berlin</i>
17:45 - 18:00	Wrapping up Day1 & information about Day 2	Hyunjung Lee, <i>Asian Voices Europe</i> Kimiko Suda, <i>Humboldt-University Berlin</i>
19:00 - 21:00	Dinner for workshop participants	

DAY 2, August 28, 2026

“East and Southeast Asian diasporic perspectives in politics, culture and civil society”

Time	Topic	Participants and moderator
09:30 - 09:40	Welcome & introduction	Hyunjung Lee, <i>Asian Voices Europe</i> Kimiko Suda, <i>Humboldt-University Berlin</i>
09:40 - 10:30	Roundtable 2: Asian diasporic representation in labor politics / trade union organization	Ongoo Buyanjargal, <i>workplace organizer, Berlin</i> Hae-Lin Choi, <i>Hands Off NYC</i> Anjannine Kyle Untalan, <i>Filipino Women's Council</i>
10:30 - 11:00	Q&A	Romin Khan, <i>ver.di, Berlin</i>
11:00 - 11:30	Coffee break	
11:30 - 12:30	Roundtable 3 Queer-feminist self-representation in culture & arts	Popo Fan, <i>filmmaker, Berlin</i> Feng-Mei Heberer, <i>New York University & University of Hong Kong</i> Olivia Hyunsin Kim artist, cultural activist, <i>Berlin</i> Ing Lee, <i>artist, Brazil</i>
12:30 - 13:00	Q&A	Sung Un Gang (TU Köln)
13:00 - 14:00	Lunch	
14:00 - 15:00	Roundtable 4: Korean Adoptee Activism	Jin Hwa Anna Borstam, <i>art curator, Krognoshuset</i> Sue Glaeser, <i>KAD e.V.</i> Mirae kh Rhee, <i>artist, Berlin, Seoul, and California.</i>
15:00 - 15:30	Q&A	Richard Lee, <i>University of Minnesota Twin Cities</i>
15:30 - 15:45	Coffee break	
15:45 - 16:30	Panel 4: Asian diasporic perspectives on political institutions and counter-measures to racism	Jee-Un Kim, <i>korientation e.V.</i> Hyunjung Lee, <i>Asian Voices Europe</i> Ann Li, <i>Untold Asian Stories</i> Leyao Rovira, <i>NO ME LLAMES CHINITA</i>
16:30 - 17:00	Q&A	Lilly Seongmoon Shim, <i>Asian Voices Europe</i>
17:00 - 17:30	Sound check	
17:30 - 18:00	Roundtable for all Review the Padlet; how to continue the network?	Hyunjung Lee, <i>Asian Voices Europe</i> Kimiko Suda, <i>Humboldt-University Berlin</i>
18:00 - 18:30	Celebrate the diversity of Asian talent in media, arts and culture	Joni Sheila & Christopher D'havé, <i>Asian Persuasion</i>

Speakers biography

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Abstracts

Keynote: Intersectional approaches to addressing anti-Asian racism: moving towards racial justice & liberation

This keynote will address anti-Asian racism with considerations of intersectionality and ways to resist oppression. Anti-Asian racism is not just something that happens on an interpersonal level, but it is something we internalize and must unlearn. Otherwise, we risk turning this oppression against ourselves, others within our communities, and towards other marginalized groups. Intersectionality explicitly recognizes that multiple, interlocking systems of oppression impact our experiences. Using an intersectional lens when considering Asian experiences allows us to understand diverse needs and provides a lens for us to examine the unique struggles of marginalized groups within the larger Asian diasporic community. We will reflect on who is considered the Asian prototype and how this reinforces power and privilege. We will examine ways that authenticity and legitimacy are contested within Asian communities with examples of LGBTQ+ Asians, multiracial Asians, and Asian adoptees. Principles of liberation psychology will be discussed to help us consider ways that we can resist oppression in society at large as well as within our own work.

Panel 1: AAR in quantitative research in Europe and the USA

This panel examines how quantitative research can make anti-Asian racism more visible while also questions the assumptions built into the production of racial data. Across European, German, and Asian American contexts, the panel addresses the persistent lack of systematic data on anti-Asian racism and shows how this absence can reinforce its social and institutional invisibility. The panel considers who approaches such as QuantCrit can combine quantitative methods with critical perspectives on race. Survey evidence further challenges simplified narrative such as the "model minority" stereotype by showing the diversity of Asian experiences and living conditions. At the same time, the panel critically examines how categories such as "Asian" are defined and how racism is conceptualized and measured.

Panel 2: Qualitative case studies on AAR and counter-narratives (self-representation)

This interdisciplinary panel will discuss the role and importance of qualitative research and community-based work to understanding and addressing anti-Asian racism in Europe. Panelists working in different national contexts and with different diasporic communities will draw on in-depth case studies as well as comparisons across contexts to discuss issues related to invisibility, exclusion, and stereotypes; discourses of race, cultural differences, and colorblindness; identity and community; intersectionality and positionality; and, social action, power, community building and agency.

Panel 3: Young scholars' panel

This interdisciplinary panel examines how Asian diasporic groups across Germany, Belgium, and the Netherlands negotiate everyday racialization, identity, and belonging. Spanning family socialization, theater, film curation, everyday encounters with whiteness, and grassroots activism, the presentations jointly explore how Asian diasporans mobilize agency, reclaim narratives, and build community against structural limitations and colonial stereotypes.

Roundtable 1: Transnational/Transpacific perspectives on public memory and Asian diasporic archive(s) from Berlin

Which strategies and formats can be used to create and sustain public memory around a particular person, social group, or historical topic? How can such practices be connected to collective histories and broader processes of social transformation and struggles for social justice? And what political, institutional, and other obstacles emerge in this work? Taking these questions as a point of departure, this roundtable explores how transnational and transpacific perspectives can pluralize public remembrance through different practices of Asian diasporic individuals and communities working from Berlin. Moving beyond nation-centered narratives, it examines how migration, colonialism, war, racialization, displacement and power dynamics shape the production, documentation, and circulation of memory. Particular attention is given to diasporic archives as dynamic spaces of knowledge, counter-memory, and self-representation, that challenge institutional silences and dominant historical narratives.

Roundtable 2: Asian diasporic representation in labor politics / trade union organization

This roundtable examines the role of Asian diasporic communities in labor politics and trade union organization across German, Italian and the US-American contexts. It asks how Asian workers have been represented within labor movements, how diasporic identities shape experiences of workplace organizing, and how unions have addressed questions of race, migration, gender, and citizenship. Bringing together diverse regional and disciplinary perspectives, the discussion will consider both the exclusions and possibilities of solidarity within labor movements. By foregrounding Asian diasporic voices and organizing practices, the roundtable seeks to rethink the histories and contemporary possibilities of transnational labor politics and collective action. Organizing based on the Asian community- and workplace-based networks might become even more important in the face of upcoming elections, the implementation of anti-migration politics and an increasingly racist public discourse about (post)migrants.

Roundtable3: Queer-feminist self-representation in culture & arts

This roundtable brings together Asian diasporic artists, activists, and cultural workers to reflect on the possibilities and limits of representation. Drawing from different diasporic, generational, and geographic contexts, we ask how artist engage questions of identity without being reduced to tokens, representatives, or narratives of trauma. We will discuss the tension between the ongoing political need for representation and the desire to move beyond its expectations: Who are we allowed to be when we are not performing identity? What forms of complexity, joy, contradiction, and individuality become possible? How do we acknowledge the struggles and achievements of previous generations while questioning inherited frameworks and building new genealogies? The conversation will also address solidarity and resource-sharing with cultural fields, asking how marginalized artists can work collectively while respecting differences. This roundtable considers how representational demands change across time and place, and how artistic practice can create space for self-determined forms of diasporic expression.

Roundtable 4: Korean Adoptee Activism

Moving across community-based research, embodied activism, and curatorial practice, this roundtable examines how Korean adoptees create knowledge about origins, family separation, belonging, (anti-)racism, and support needs. The KAD-WAVE pilot survey presents initial findings from internationally adopted people in Germany with focus on access to records, searches for origins, and racialized experiences. *Run Toward My Family* explores long-distance running as an embodied practice of return, remembrance, and activism across the global geography of Korean adoption. *Fragments of Adoption* considers exhibition as making a space for dialogue and asks how the legacies of adoption extend beyond adoptees themselves to children and subsequent generations. Together, the panel foregrounds adoptee perspectives while connecting personal experiences to the broader histories of transnational adoption.

Panel 4: Asian diasporic perspectives on political institutions and counter-measures to racism

This panel examines Asian diasporic perspectives on political institutions, anti-Asian racism, and anti-racist advocacy across Belgium, Germany, Spain and at the EU-context. Panelists discuss how anti-Asian racism remains under-recognized within political agendas, public debate, data collection, and institutional anti-racism frameworks, while increasingly polarized, anti-immigration, and far-right discourses intensify pressures on racialized communities. Drawing on grassroots activism, research and community organizing events, the discussion highlights strategies including data-driven advocacy, coalition building, political education, media and debate training, self-representation, intersectional organizing, and engagement with national and EU institutions. Particular attention is given to the diversity of Asian diasporic experiences and the need to address racism in relation to gender, migration, adoption, queerness, belonging, and other intersecting identities. The panel also considers the sustainability of activism under systemic discrimination, political pressure, and shrinking resources. Beyond resistance, speakers reflect on activism as a source of community, care, critical consciousness, belonging, solidarity, and joy, emphasizing the importance of creating spaces in which Asian diasporic communities can define their own narratives and collectively pursue social and political change.

Joni Sheila & Christopher D'havé, Asian Persuasion

Our mission is to celebrate and amplify the rich diversity of Asian talent in media, arts, and culture. We are dedicated to providing a platform for this cause. By fostering a supportive and inclusive community, we aim to break down barriers, challenge stereotypes, and promote greater representation and visibility of Asian people in Belgium (and beyond). Our goal is to amplify Asian voices in art, media, and society: not as tokens but as full, complex storytellers. We create space for underrepresented talent to be seen, heard and celebrated through performances, panels and community-building initiatives.